

MAY

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Grant's coordinated offensives against the various Confederate armies get underway.

MAY 5-6

In Virginia, Grant and Lee first clash in the fiery Battle of the Wilderness.

MAY 7

In Georgia, Sherman confronts General Joseph E. Johnston's Army of Tennessee.

MAY 8-21

In Virginia, the "Bloody Angle" struggle on May 12 marks the fiercest fighting in the Battle of Spotsylvania.

MAY 11

A major Union cavalry raid on Richmond, led by General Philip Sheridan, encounters General Jeb Stuart's Confederate horsemen at Yellow Tavern, only 6 miles (9.5km) north of the city. Stuart is mortally wounded.